FLE TRIBE

BONUS COURSE · TAILWIND CSS · THURSDAY · LESSON GUIDE

Tailwind at scale

This course: Style React apps fast with Tailwind's utility classes, and compare it with Bootstrap.

Your brand in the theme

In Tailwind v4 you define your design tokens in CSS with `@theme`. Every token becomes a class automatically.

```
@import "tailwindcss";

@theme {
  --color-brand: #3f09c9;
  --color-lime: #b6ff00;
  --font-display: "Montserrat", sans-serif;
}

/* now you can use bg-brand, text-lime, font-display */
```

Avoiding class soup

- When the same long class list repeats, make a **component** (e.g. a React `Button`) instead of copying it.
- Use `@apply` rarely, for things you can't make a component, such as styling HTML you don't control.
- Keep class order consistent (layout → spacing → colour → type → states) so lists are easy to scan.

Accessibility checks

- Text needs a contrast ratio of at least **4.5:1** against its background (check with a contrast checker).
- Never remove focus outlines without replacing them, e.g. `focus-visible:outline-2`.
- Don't rely on colour alone to show meaning: add text or an icon too.

Research questions

Answer these in the app, in your own words, to unlock the next lesson.

1. Define brand colors in your theme and use them.
2. When is `@apply` acceptable?

Start your research here

- Tailwind docs: https://tailwindcss.com/docs/theme
- Tailwind docs: https://tailwindcss.com/docs/dark-mode